

OSF X ANDELA HACKATHON 2026 · INFORMATION YOU CAN TRUST

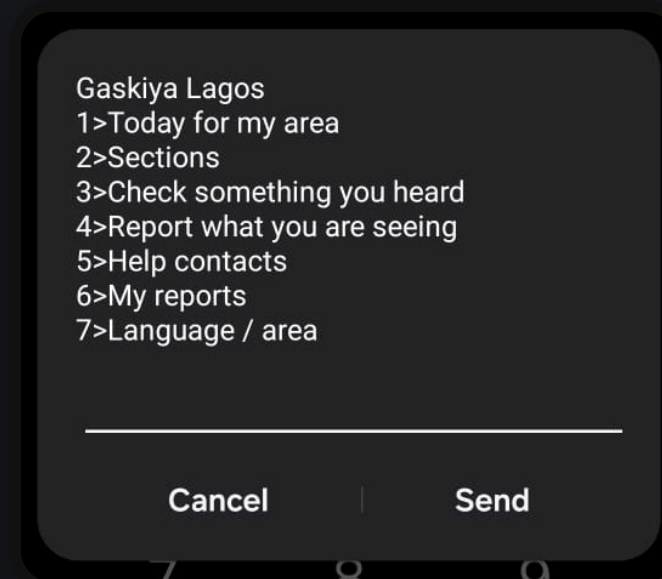
Gaskiya

A daily civic paper on any phone. Sourced, dated, in your language, with a next step on every item.

***425*078#**

LIVE NOW

Dial from any MTN, Glo or 9mobile line in Nigeria. No app, no data.



Real handset, live network, 19 Sep 2026

Olamigoke Olabampe

Cross-track: Stability & Social Cohesion · Safety, Reporting & Protection

Gaskiya is Hausa for truth, after the newspaper *Gaskiya Ta Fi Kwabo*: truth is worth more than a penny.

THE PROBLEM

When a curfew changes at 4pm, who tells the market?

Official notices are hard to reach

Curfews, aid points, vaccination drives and deadlines are published as PDFs, press releases and website posts. Most people affected never see them.

Rumours are easy to reach

Word of mouth and forwarded messages move faster than any notice. In fragile areas a false "they are coming tonight" can move a whole neighbourhood.

The phone in the pocket is basic

Feature phones, no data bundle, patchy networks and many languages. Information tools built for smartphones and English skip the people who need them most.

The gap is not a lack of information. It is that trusted information does not arrive where people are, in a form they can act on.

Two users, one loop

Readers

Anyone with a GSM phone in a place where notices matter and trust is thin.

- A trader in Kano who needs tonight's curfew hours, not last week's.
- A mother in Maiduguri who heard the food point moved.
- A family at Bulengo camp near Goma told they must relocate.
- A herder in Kaduna who wants the dialogue sitting, not the fight.

Moderators

The people communities already trust to verify, given a desk that sorts for them.

- Peace committees and state peace commissions.
- Protection clusters and humanitarian information officers.
- Community radio and local government information units.
- Partners like Build Up working with local peacebuilders.

THE SOLUTION

The newspaper, on USSD, in your language

Gaskiya Kano

- 1 Yau na yankina
- 2 Sashe-sashe
- 3 Duba abin da ka ji
- 4 Bayar da abin da kake gani
- 5 Lambobin taimako
- 6 Rahotannina
- 7 Harshe / yanki

Main menu · Hausa · 143 characters

Yau 18 Sept

- 1 An rage gajarta dokar hana fita Kano
- 2 Ranar karshe NIN-SIM 30 Sep
- 3 Sanarwa kan kwalara a jihohi
- 5
- 0 Menu

Front page for Kano · top three items today

An rage gajarta dokar hana fita Kano. Gwamnatin Jihar Kano ta rage dokar hana fita a kananan hukumomin Kano da Nassarawa. Yanzu dokar tana aiki daga karfe 10 na dare zuwa 5 na safe. (1/3)

- 1 Kari
- 0 Menu

Item page 1 of 3 · "Kari" = More

Sourced and dated

The last page of every item names the source and date. Nothing is shown without one.

A next step, always

"Abin da za a yi" (what to do): where to go, who to call, what to bring, by when.

Paginated, not squeezed

Up to three screens per item with a More key. Every screen fits 160 characters, enforced by tests.

THE SOLUTION, CONTINUED

The same paper in English, for Lagos

Gaskiya Lagos

- 1 Today for my area
- 2 Sections
- 3 Check something you heard
- 4 Report what you are seeing
- 5 Help contacts
- 6 My reports
- 7 Language / area

Main menu · English · 148 characters · as
on the cover photo

Today 19 Sept

- 1 Lagos flood alert 19 to 21
Sep
- 2 NIN-SIM linking deadline 30
Sep
- 3 Cholera advisory in 5 states
- 0 Menu

Front page for Lagos · local alert first,
national notices after

Lagos flood alert 19 to 21
Sep. NiMet forecasts heavy
rain across Lagos from Friday
19 to Sunday 21 September.
(1/5)
1 More
0 Menu

Item page 1 of 5

What to do: Call LASEMA on 767 or 112 if trapped.
Move to higher ground early if your street
flooded in July. (4/5)
1 More
0 Menu

The next step, always its own line

Source: NiMet weather advisory / LASEMA, 17 Sept.
(5/5)
9 Back
0 Menu

The last page names the source and its date

Readers report. Humans verify. The front page updates.

CHECK

Check something you heard

Type the rumour. It is tested against trusted notices only. Verdict, source and date come back in your language.

REPORT

Report what you are seeing

Four screens, no name, no number kept. A reference code and an emergency contact come back at once.

SORT

The model triages

Translates to English, strips private names, sets urgency, groups similar reports into clusters. Never publishes.

VERIFY

A moderator publishes

Writes what a trusted source confirms, names the source. It goes to the front page. The reporter sees "Verified, published".

```
BA GASKIYA BA. Ba a cire dokar hana fita ba. Kano  
ta takaita ta zuwa 10pm zuwa 5am. Wannan labari  
karya ne. (1/2)
```

```
1 Kari
```

```
0 Menu
```

```
Live rumour check in Hausa: "NOT TRUE. The curfew was not lifted..." ·  
then the source line
```

```
Thank you. Reference KN-9861. No name or number  
is kept. If you are in danger now: Emergency  
(police, fire, ambulance) 112
```

```
1 Help contacts
```

```
0 Menu
```

```
Report received · 145 characters
```

Designed so the system cannot invent a fact

- **Cite or say UNVERIFIED.** The rumour checker may only say CONFIRMED or NOT TRUE when it names a specific trusted notice. The server re-checks that the notice exists.
- **Community reports never confirm.** Clusters appear only as "N people reported something similar. Not yet verified.", and only above five reports.
- **Humans publish.** Nothing reaches the front page without a moderator writing the verified text and naming the source.
- **Honest fallback.** If the model is slow or down, a keyword fallback answers UNVERIFIED and points to any related notice. The line never goes silent.

Measured, not asserted

40-claim eval run against the live model, 18 Sep 2026

Accuracy	97.5%
False confirmations	0
Wrong source cited	0
Time per check	~1.2 s

The one miss was the safe kind: an UNVERIFIED where NOT TRUE was justified.

`npm run eval` reproduces it.

THE BRIEF'S SEVEN CONSTRAINTS

Every constraint has a concrete answer

CONSTRAINT	HOW GASKIYA ANSWERS IT
Trust and verification	Source and date on every item. Cite-or-UNVERIFIED guard. Human publication. Public eval.
Low bandwidth, basic devices	USSD on any GSM phone, zero data. Every screen under 160 characters. One machine always warm so no cold start eats the session.
Accessibility and inclusion	Numbered menus, at most one free-text step, plain ASCII so it renders on any handset.
Privacy and security	Phone numbers salted-hashed before storage. No names. Five-report threshold before anything is visible. 90-day purge.
Multilingual access	English, French, Arabic, Portuguese, Kiswahili, Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo, plus Other : type any language and the interface is localised on the spot and cached.
Local relevance	Countries, areas, contacts and notices are data files. Six countries, 27 areas seeded.
Clear next steps	A mandatory "What to do" line on every item. Emergency contact shown the moment a safety report is filed.

Countries are data. Gateways are adapters.

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COUNTRIES SEEDED

Nigeria, Kenya, DR Congo, Sudan, Mozambique, Mali. 27 areas. Adding one is a JSON edit and a translation run.

9

LANGUAGE OPTIONS

Eight fixed packs generated offline. "Other" is translated live the first time a language is asked for, then cached for everyone after.

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GATEWAY ADAPTERS

Qrios (live) and an Africa's Talking-style plain-text endpoint. A new gateway is about ten lines. The state machine never changes.

Live on a real network today

Provisioned on Qrios and reachable on MTN, Glo and 9mobile across Nigeria. Deployed on Fly.io with persistent storage. This is not a simulator demo; the screenshot on the cover is a phone.

Cheap to run

All content is pre-generated. Only two things call the model inside a session: the rumour check (about a second) and the first request for a new language. Everything else is a lookup.

AI built it, AI runs inside it, and the failures were caught

Built with Claude Code

One person, one day. The assistant read the Qrios OpenAPI spec and implemented the exact callback protocol, wrote the state machine, adapters, dashboard, simulator, generator, eval and tests, and drove full sessions over HTTP before any UI existed.

DeepSeek Flash inside

JSON-mode calls validated against schemas. Localises strings and notices into eight languages offline. Live: the rumour verdict and on-demand languages. After the reply: report triage. It never publishes and never sees a phone number.

What went wrong, and the fix

First generation run: most items came back empty. Cause: the model's chain-of-thought was on by default and ate the token budget. Fix: thinking off, retries, resume. Then "Arabic" drifted into Hausa for Nigerian notices. Fix: unambiguous language prompts and a drift check. Both are documented in the repo.

Guard rails over trust. ASCII-only output for GSM handsets, length budgets per screen, placeholder integrity checks, non-empty field checks, a hard "cite a real notice or say UNVERIFIED" rule enforced in code, and a 40-claim eval anyone can rerun with `npm run eval`.

From proof of concept to a line a community relies on

Next 90 days

- Daily ingestion of official feeds (state governments, NCDC, NEMA, OCHA, INEC) into the same item shape, replacing sample content.
- A pilot with one state peace commission or protection cluster as moderators, starting with Kano or Plateau.
- Notices, not only menus, translated on demand for "Other" languages.
- SMS fallback for anyone whose session drops mid-read.

Why it matters

- A rumour answered in a second, in Hausa, with a source, is a rumour that does not move a neighbourhood.
- A report that becomes a verified notice by evening closes the loop most reporting tools leave open.
- It runs on the phone people already own, on the network they already use, at no data cost.

***425*078#**

Live: gaskiya.fly.dev (simulator and moderator desk)

Code: github.com/devgoks/gaskiya

Olamigoke Olabampe · OSF x Andela Hackathon 2026